



Naomi - Xiao Li

Student ID
35963328

"someone once made this JOURNEY before you."

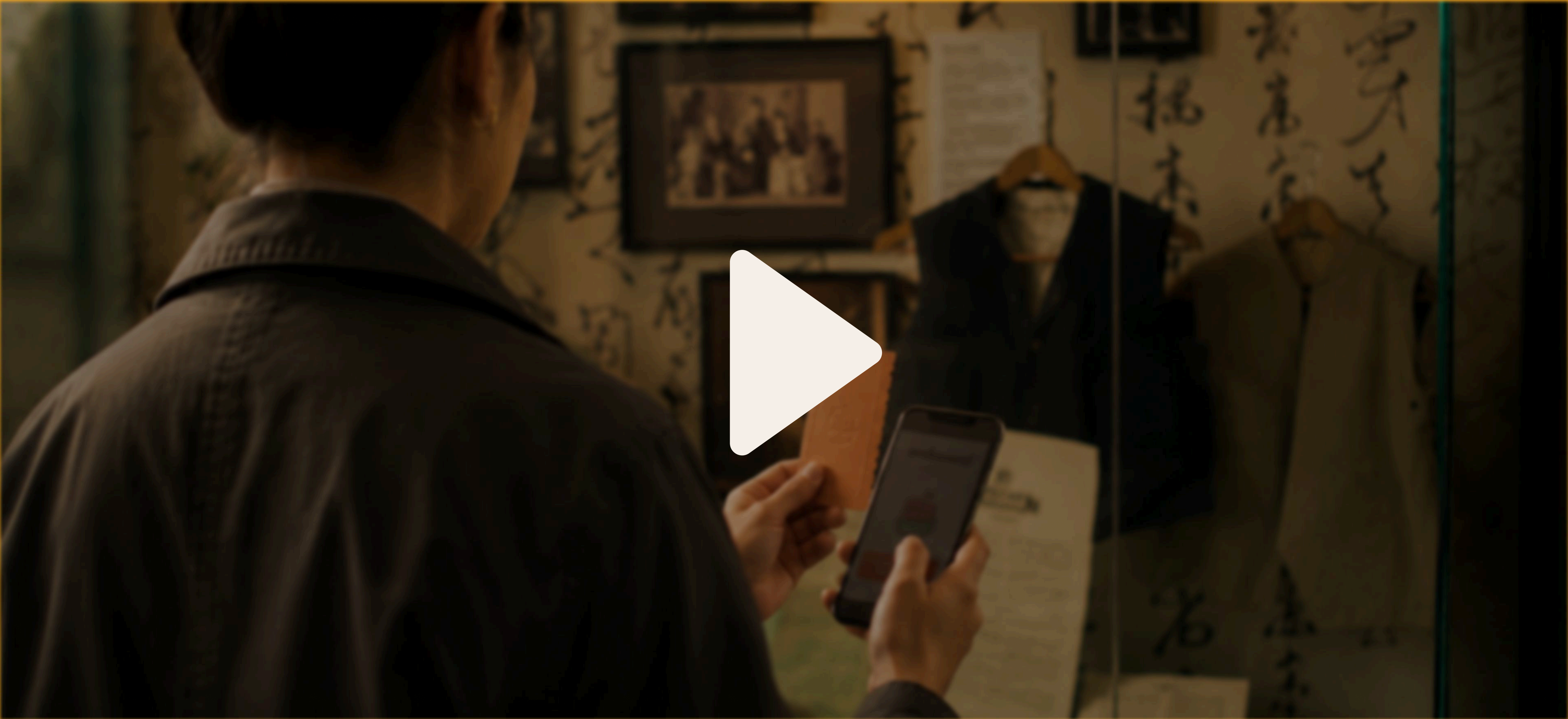
ON BOARD

A Participatory Design Intervention for the Immigration Museum, Melbourne

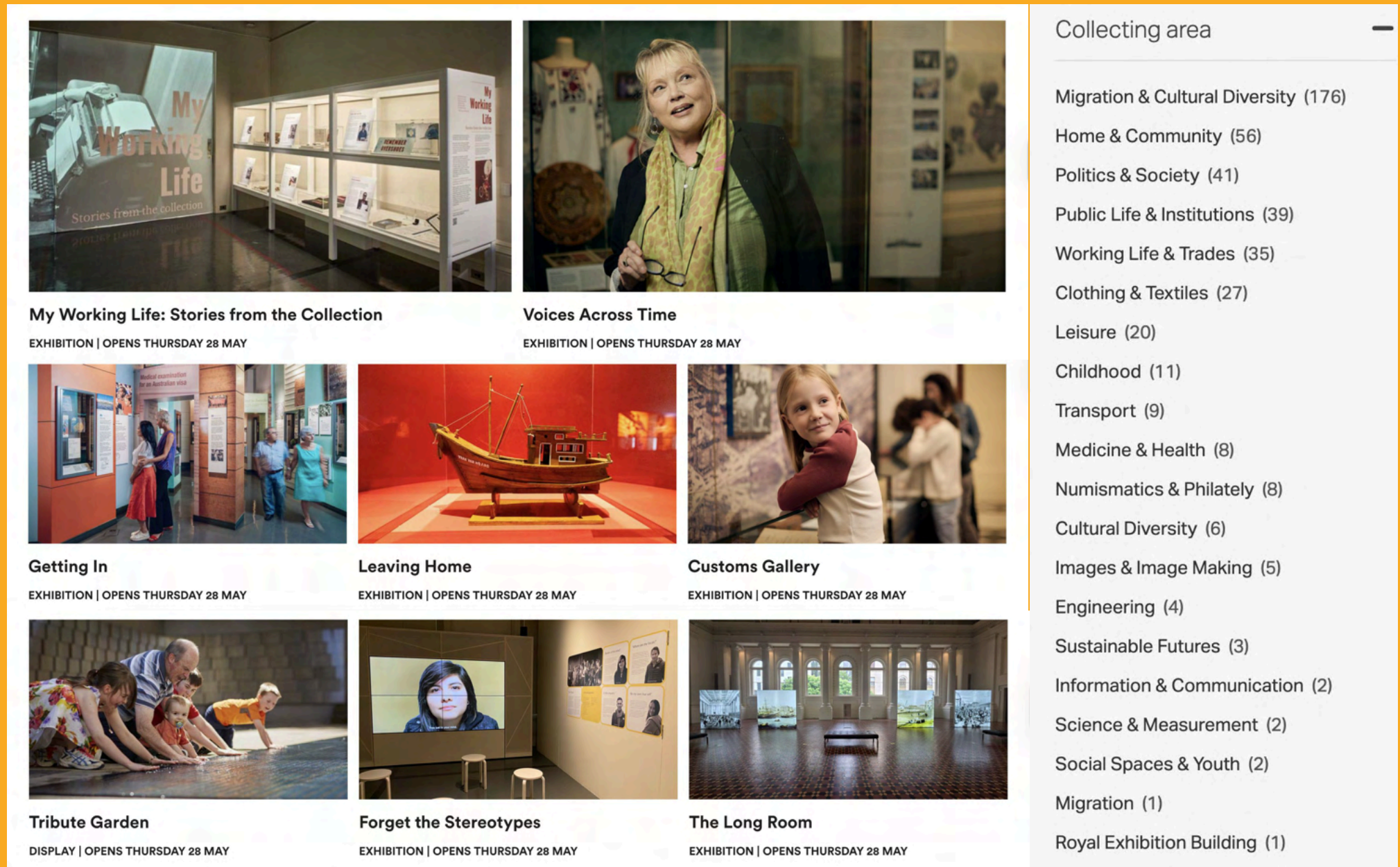


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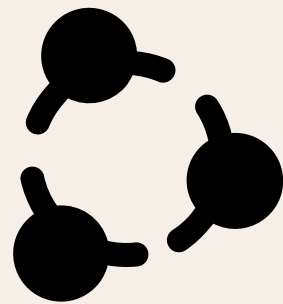
THE OPPORTUNITY



The Immigration Museum holds one of the most complete collections of real migrant narratives in Australia — personal documents, objects, photographs, and first-person accounts spanning generations.

A FRAGMENTED EXPERIENCE

The museum houses multiple exhibitions across its building — rich in content, but **disconnected from one another**. There is no unifying thread guiding visitors through the space or linking one story to the next.



NO CLEAR NAVIGATION

Without clear wayfinding, visitors move through the building in a non-linear, often accidental order. The result is a journey shaped by architecture, not by meaning.



THE VISITOR REMAINS A BYSTANDER

Even where interactive elements exist, **the experience is fundamentally observational**. Visitors pass through exhibitions as spectators — learning about migrant stories, but never entering them.



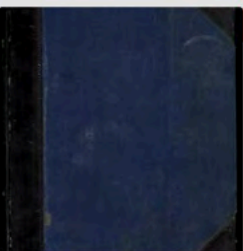
THE OPPORTUNITY

● THE GAP

On Board is designed for exactly this audience — and exactly this moment.

THE ARCHIVE EXISTS

Thousands of real migrant narratives — documents, objects, oral histories — already held in the collection. Waiting to be activated, not added to.



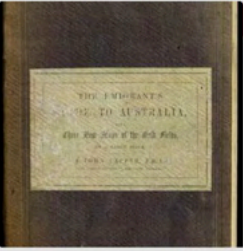
Item

HT 13450.1

Diary - David Yuille, 'City of Dunedin' & S.S. 'Albion', 1872

Leisure, Migration & Cultural Diversity, Public Life & Institutions

Diary written by David Yuille who came to Victoria via New Zealand from Scotland on 21 September 1872, for his health. The diary contains daily entries which ...



Item

HT 4921

Book - John Capper, 'The Emigrant's Guide to Australia', George Philip & Son, 1853

Migration & Cultural Diversity

Book entitled 'The Emigrant's Guide to Australia', published by George Philip and Son, Liverpool, London, Dublin and Glasgow in 1853. Written by John Capper, the book includes the subtitle: ...

THE COMMUNITY EXISTS

Melbourne is home to one of the most diverse migrant populations in the world. These communities are looking for spaces that truly belong to them — not just spaces about them.

41.2%

140 CULTURES

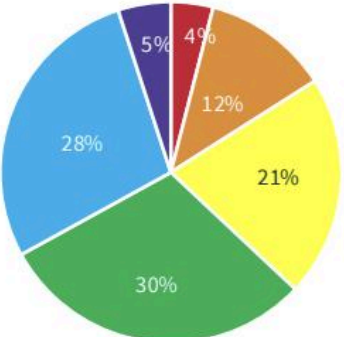
105,000V

THE AUDIENCE IS CHANGING

Immigration Museum Visitors

Jan-Dec 2023

n=281

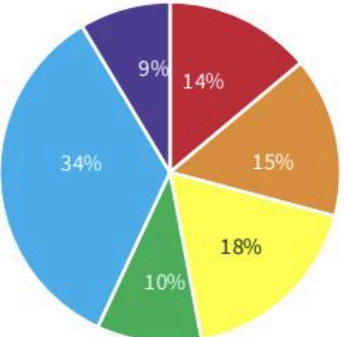


In 2023, IM welcomed a large proportion of **Informed**, **Curious** and **Obligated**

Joy Visitors

Feb-Mar 2024

n=151

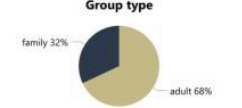


Joy immediately attracted a new audience with an uplift of **Easy Going**, **Connected** and **Elite** compared to general IM Visitation

Easy Going	Seek interactions with surroundings and social experiences
Connected	Seek out locations and events to share collective experiences
Obligated	Feel responsible to experience different things in life with others
Informed	Strive for constant personal growth and learning
Curious	Gain a sense of intellectual superiority through depth of knowledge
Elite	Seek exclusivity and prestige

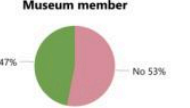
FY 2023-24

Group type



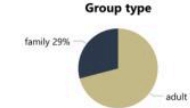
Family 32%
New and repeat visitors 68%

Museum member



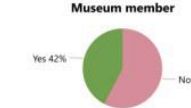
Yes 47%
No 53%

New and repeat visitors



Repeat visitor 48%
New visitor 52%

Employment status



Work part time 21%
Work full time 40%
Not working 39%

Segment (updated monthly)



Elite 14%
Curious 25%
Informed 19%
Obligated 18%
Connected 15%
Easygoing 9%

Education level



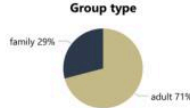
Degree or higher 72%
Diploma or lower 27%
Prefer not to say 1%

Average personal income in A\$ p.a.

\$73,835

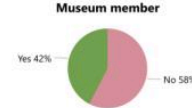
FY 2024-25

Group type



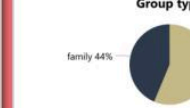
Family 29%
New and repeat visitors 71%

Museum member



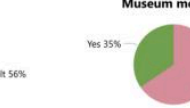
Yes 42%
No 58%

New and repeat visitors



Repeat visitor 48%
New visitor 52%

Employment status



Work part time 22%
Work full time 45%
Not working 33%

Segment (updated monthly)



Elite 23%
Curious 24%
Informed 18%
Obligated 14%
Connected 13%
Easygoing 7%

Education level

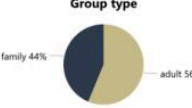
Degree or higher 72%
Diploma or lower 24%
Prefer not to say 2%

Average personal income in A\$ p.a.

\$74,396

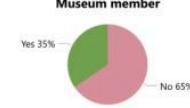
FY 2025-26 (To Dec 2025)

Group type



Family 44%
New and repeat visitors 56%

Museum member



Yes 35%
No 65%

New and repeat visitors



Repeat visitor 41%
New visitor 59%

Employment status

Work part time 24%
Work full time 43%
Not working 33%

Segment (updated monthly)

Elite 14%
Curious 23%
Informed 22%
Obligated 21%
Connected 10%
Easygoing 10%

Education level

Degree or higher 85%
Diploma or lower 12%
Prefer not to say 3%

Average personal income in A\$ p.a.

\$77,889

LEARNINGS: The visitor profile of IM is changing. In the current financial year, IM is welcoming more family groups than previously. Also, slightly more new (first time visitors) and less members. Visitors are highly educated (currently 85% with a degree or higher) and personal income is increasing over time. With regards to motivation to visit, the IM visitor is slightly more likely to be there for their own individual benefits (Elite, Curious, Informed), compared to a collective benefit shared with others/the group (easy-going, connected, obligated) – but these ‘group’ benefit segments may be on the rise.

"SOMEONE ONCE MADE THIS JOURNEY BEFORE YOU."

ON BOARD

A participatory journey through the Immigration Museum — and beyond.



HOW IT WORKS

01 Get your On Board ticket



Connects you to a real historical migrant.

Pick up your physical ticket at the entrance. You'll be paired with a historical migrant.

02 Scan moments as you explore



Tap to collect moments that resonate with you.

Tap your ticket at key touchpoints to collect emotional milestones.

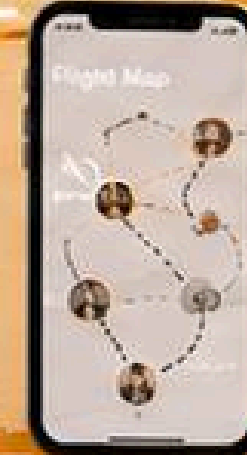
03 Explore Tap NFC



Use your phone to unlock stories, hear voices, and discover your fellow traveller.

→ Flight Map —

Scan your ticket QR at any moment during the visit. See where you are, what you've visited, and where your fellow traveller's story continues next. Available anytime, no interruption to the experience.



04 Meet your fellow traveller



See how your fellow traveller experienced the same milestones.

05 Share your story

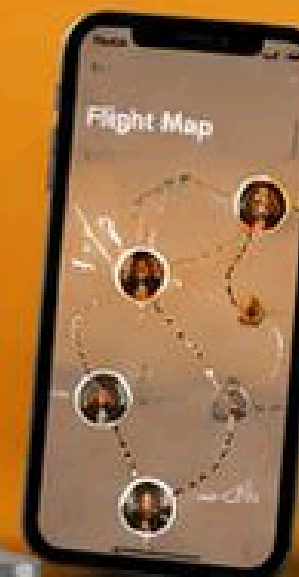


At the final installation, share your migration story, memories, or reflections.

the journey continues beyond the exit.

06 On Board Digital Platform

A living archive of migrant voices.



Events & community hub.

A community that grows together.



@ONBOARD

Stories Archive

Flight Map

Events

Community

HOW IT WORKS

← BACK TO JOURNEY

YOUR FLIGHT MAP

Explore the museum. Tap NFC points to collect moments and discover your fellow traveller's story.

YOUR FELLOW TRAVELLER



LI WEI

From: Shanghai, China

Year: 1954

Ship: SS Neusa

TICKET ID

IMM-2026-04821



Scan again anytime at home

YOUR JOURNEY

ARRIVAL

Start here

✓

GALLERY 1

Life On Board

✓

GALLERY 2

Food & Belonging

✓

GALLERY 3

Work & Hope

You are here

GALLERY 4

Identity & Culture

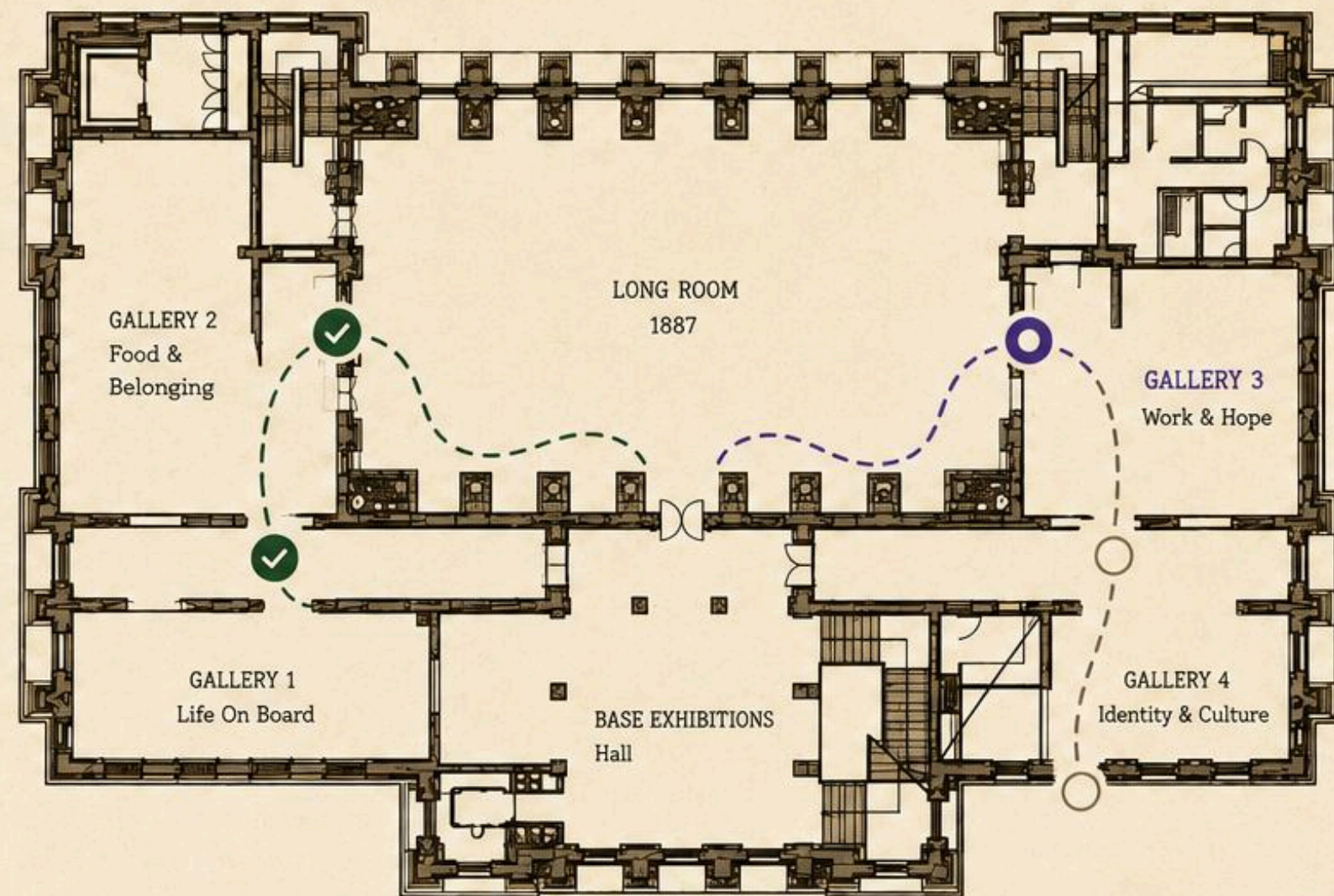
GALLERY 5

Arrival in Melbourne

PROGRESS

3 / 5

moments collected



GALLERY 2

Food & Belonging

LONG ROOM

1887

GALLERY 3

Work & Hope

GALLERY 1

Life On Board

BASE EXHIBITIONS

Hall

GALLERY 4

Identity & Culture

✓ Visited

○ Current location

○ Not yet visited

Tap NFC points at each gallery

CURRENT MOMENT

Work & Hope

Discover how Li Wei navigated new opportunities and challenges in a new land.



NEXT STOP

Identity & Culture

Explore how Li Wei found community and held on to her heritage.



SCAN YOUR TICKET ANYTIME

View your journey progress, collected moments and where your fellow traveller's story continues next.



JOURNEY

MAP

MOMENTS

NFC POINTS

COMMUNITY

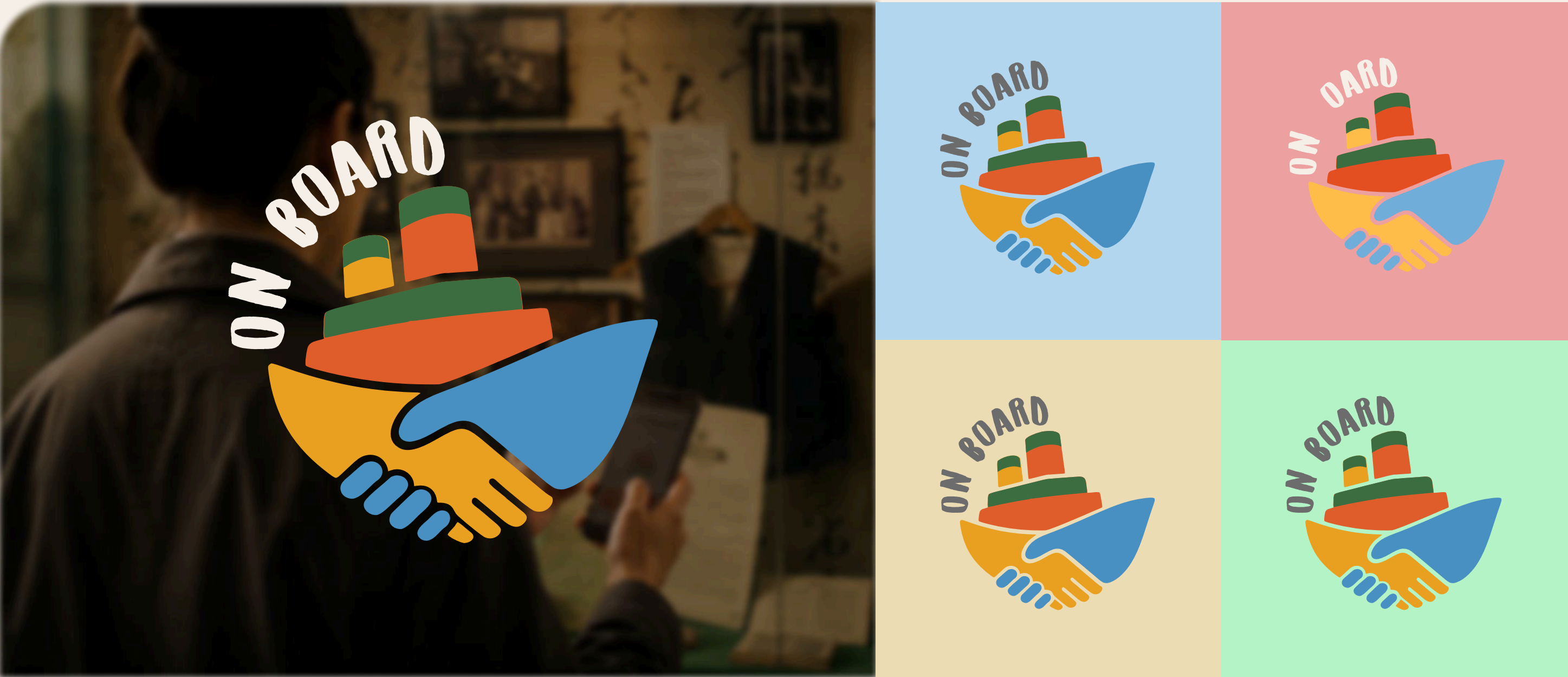


ViSUAL iDENTiTY

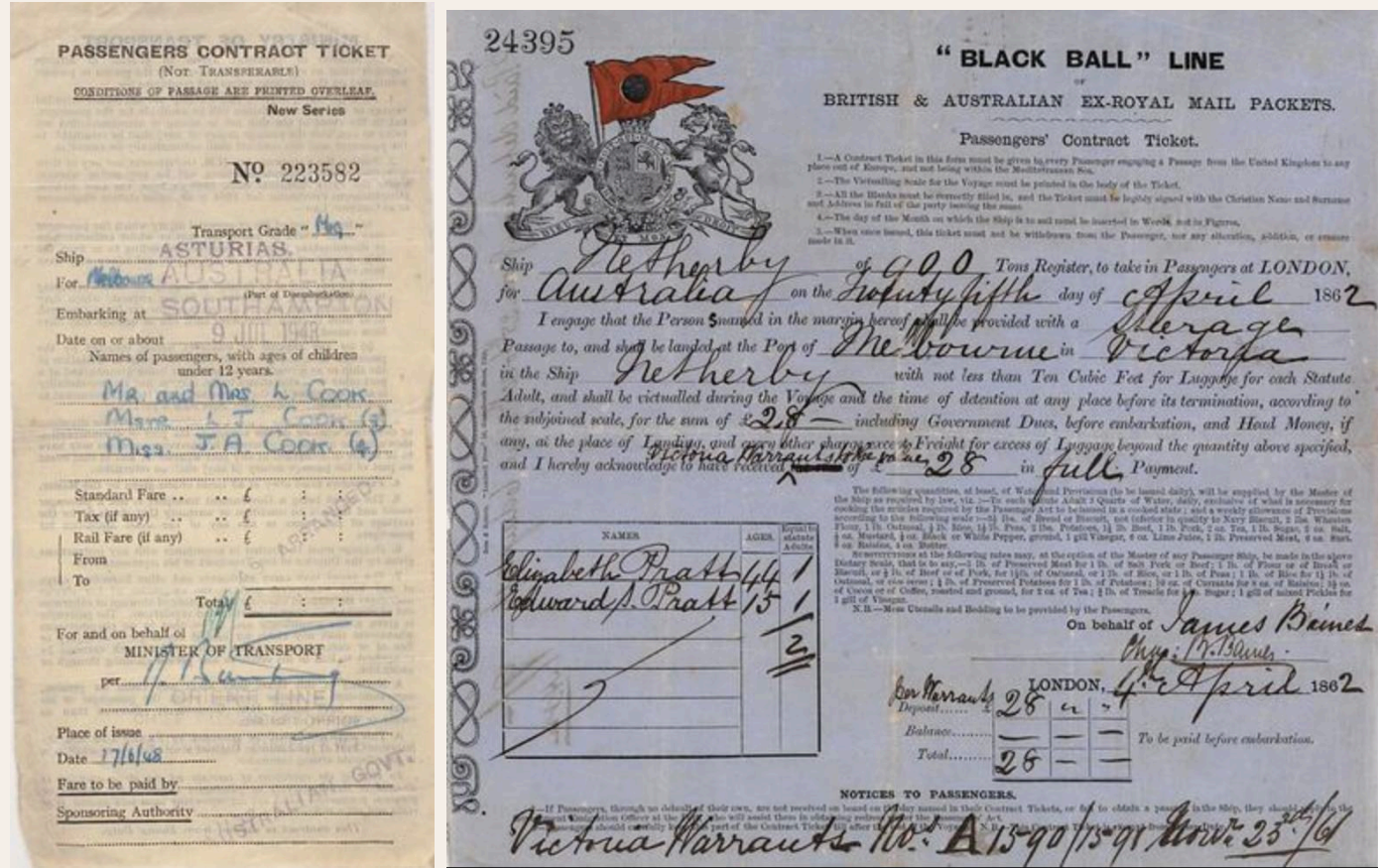
A heritage palette would tell visitors: this is the past. On Board uses dopamine colour and handwritten type to send a different signal — these stories carry the same energy as your life today.

MiGRATION iS NOT HiSTORY. iT iS ALiVE.

#F9AB22	#E05D2B	#4990C1	#3C6E41	#F5F0E8



Visual identity



Hi. WEI CHEN

DATE OF VISIT

28 May 2026

TICKET NUMBER

IMM - 2026 - WC - 0528

Someone once made this journey before you.

Samuel Louey Gung

SHIP NAME

SS SHANSI LINE

BORN CARLTON, MELBOURNE · 1920

DEPARTED HONG KONG · SS SHANSI · 28 JUL 1947

CONNECT OBJECT RESPOND

3/5

●



Book - Chinese
Book with Chinese character text, published in Shanghai in 1898. It contains text relating to Christian life lessons and was ...
[Read more](#)

●



Photograph - Family
Photograph of the Gung family at Mary and Samuel Gung's family home. The family are

Flowler

Journey

Community

THE EXPERIENCE iN ACTION

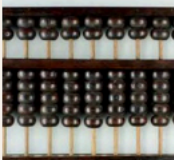
FELLOW TRAVELLER

Article : Gung Family Collection ×

63 results < 1 of 2 >



Item
HT 3371624
Sauce Dish - Dinner Set, Chinese, Samuel Louey Gung, Melbourne, circa 1950s
Migration & Cultural Diversity, Home & Community
Small sauce dish which is part of a Chinese dinner set in use from the early 1950s in Melbourne by Samuel Louey Gung and his family. Samuel Louey Gung, the son of Sydney Louey Gung. ...



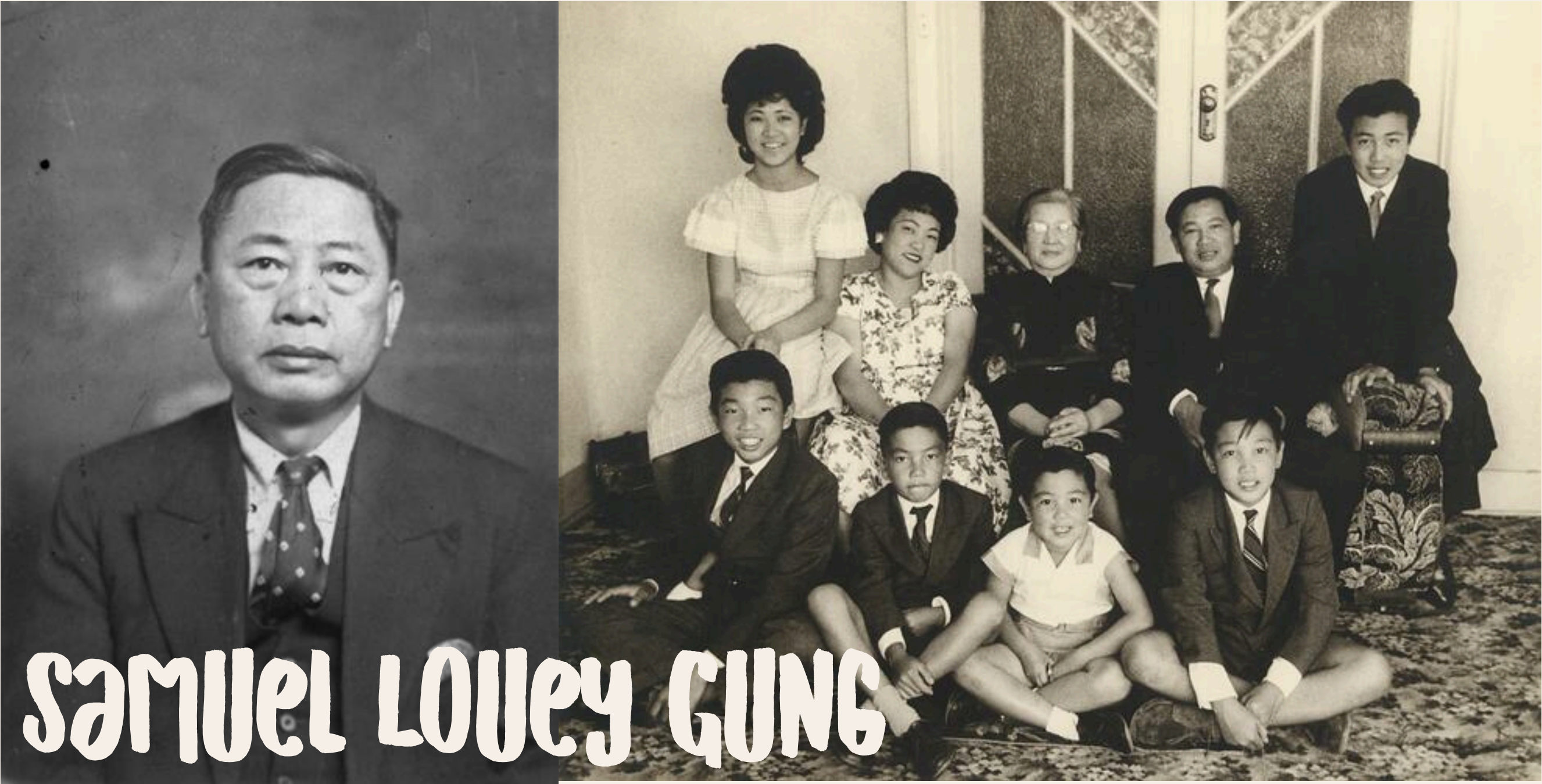
Item
HT 33704
Abacus - Sydney Louey Gung, China, circa 1900s
Migration & Cultural Diversity
Wooden abacus used by Sydney Louey Gung, possibly purchased in Australia or brought with Sydney from China during the early 1900s. Sydney Louey Gung migrated to Australia from China in about 1900 at ...



Item
HT 33714
Wedding Invitation - Chinese, Samuel Louey Gung & Mary Mak, Hong Kong, 6 Dec 1941
Migration & Cultural Diversity
Wedding invitation featuring lotus and duck symbols and written in Chinese characters. Samuel Gung and Mary Mak were married in Australia in 1941. Consequently, they did not have a Chinese marriage ...



Item
HT 33711
Calligraphy Pen - Samuel Louey Gung, China, circa 1940s
Migration & Cultural Diversity, Working Life & Trades
Ivory calligraphy pen which belonged to Samuel Louey Gung and was used in Melbourne from the 1940s. Samuel Louey Gung, the son of Sydney Louey Gung, was born in Carlton in ...



NAME LOUEY GUNG
Mary
 Address 24 Madure St
Ascot Vale
 Nationality Chinese
 Place of Birth Kwang Tung Prov.
 Date of Birth 12-11-23
 Single or Married Married
 Occupation H.W.
 Arrived in Australia on 10-11-47
 Port of Melbourne via Shanghai
 Signature of Holder Mary L. Gung
 Certificate issued at Melbourne
 Issued by For COMMONWEALTH IMMIGRATION OFFICE

Personal Description:
 Height 5 ft 2 ins.
 Build medium
 Eyes dark Hair black
 Remarks See photo

1



Look and Live/
 CROSS CROSSINGS CAUTIONS

Date 18-51 Receipt No. 128249 Licence No. 0130037 Glass Asympt. Patic-O

Received amount printed above.

WARNING.—This Licence shall have no effect until the Cash Register imprint appears hereon.

Collector of Imposts.

NOT TRANSFERABLE. Section 6, Motor Car Act 1928, No. 3741, as amended by Motor Car Act 1935.

The Bearer
 (Permanent Address) Mr. Samuel L. Gung,
79 Arden St.,
NORTH MELBOURNE.

LICENCE
 No. 738 037.

is, on payment of a FEE of 5/-, receipt of which must be shown by Cash Register imprint hereon, licensed to drive a Motor Car (other than a Motor Cycle) on any public highway in the State of Victoria, FOR THE YEAR ENDING 10th May, 1952.

Signature of Driver ALEX. M. DUNCAN,
 Chief Commissioner of Police.

Form No. 2
 Commonwealth of Australia.
 Immigration Act 1901-1949.

State of VICTORIA Port of MELBOURNE
 Date of Issue 26 May 1947 Number 740

CERTIFICATE OF EXEMPTION.

This is to Certify that Samuel Louey Gung who is described hereunder, is authorized to enter or remain in the Commonwealth without being subject to any of the provisions of the Immigration Act 1901-1949 restricting entry into or stay in the Commonwealth.

This certificate shall be in force for a period of 30 months from the 30th day of June, 1947.

Nationality Chinese Birthplace Shanghai Age 24

Particular Marks H.B.

Occupation H.W.

Signature of Person exempted Mary L. Gung

By authority of the Minister for Immigration 18/05/47

- Born Carlton, Melbourne
- 1920 Returned via SS Shansi
 - Hong Kong → Melbourne
 - 1947 Travelling with wife Mary
 - children Phyllis & Jeff Ticket no. IMM — 1947 — SLG

THE EXPERIENCE iN ACTION



"I often wonder whether it is possible to feel at home in a place that did not shape your childhood."

WEI CHEN

THE VISITOR PERSONA



NAME
Wei Chen



AGE
34



ORIGIN
Chengdu, China



NOW LIVES IN
Brunswick, Melbourne



ARRIVED IN AUSTRALIA
2018 (student visa → PR)



LANGUAGE
Mandarin / intermediate English



VISITING WITH
Alone, on a Saturday afternoon



REASON FOR VISIT
Recommended by a colleague



WHO WEI IS

Wei moved to Melbourne in 2018 to complete a master's degree in urban planning. After graduating, she stayed — first on a graduate visa, then permanent residency. She lives in Brunswick, shops at the Queen Victoria Market on weekends, and has developed a quiet but deep attachment to Melbourne.

She often wonders whether it is possible to feel at home in a place that did not shape your childhood.

She has never been to the Immigration Museum. A colleague mentioned it after Wei said she sometimes feels invisible in conversations about 'Australian identity.' She arrives on a Saturday afternoon without much expectation.



PERSONALITY
Thoughtful, observant, curious



GOALS
Connect with stories, understand belonging, feel seen



NEEDS
Meaningful connection, inclusive storytelling, space to reflect



WHAT SHE VALUES
Authenticity, diversity, community, learning from others

WEI CHEN'S JOURNEY ON BOARD

A personal journey through the Immigration Museum — and beyond.



WEI CHEN, 34

- 📍 Chengdu, China
- ✈️ Arrived in Australia in 2018 (student visa → PR)
- 🏠 Lives in Brunswick, Melbourne
- 🗓️ Visiting the museum alone, on a Saturday afternoon
- 💬 Recommended by a colleague

“I often wonder whether it is possible to feel at home in a place that did not shape your childhood.”

THE EXPERIENCE IN ACTION

STAGES	01 ARRIVAL Stepping into the Museum	02 GET TICKET Receiving her On Board ticket	03 EXPLORE & CONNECT Scanning NFC points and discovering stories	04 SEE & FEEL TOGETHER Discovering how her fellow traveller felt the same milestones	05 SHARE YOUR STORY Contributing her own story at the final installation	06 BEYOND THE MUSEUM Staying connected through the digital platform
ACTIONS	- Enters the museum curious and open - Notices the On Board intervention	- Collects her physical ticket at the entrance - Reads the introduction and meets her historical fellow traveller	- Taps NFC points throughout the exhibitions - Uncovers moments from her fellow traveller's journey	- Sees how her fellow traveller experienced the same moments - Feels a connection across time	- Writes or records her own story - Submits her memory or reflection	- Receives follow-up via the platform - Engages with events, community stories and new exhibitions
THINKING & FEELING	Curious "I'm not sure what to expect."	Interested "This is different. I want to know more."	Engaged "These stories feel so personal and real."	Connected "Their journey resonates with me."	Reflective "My story matters too."	Belonging "I'm part of an ongoing story."
TOUCHPOINTS	Museum entrance Signage & staff Atmosphere	Ticket desk Physical ticket Introduction panel	NFC touchpoints Exhibition content Audio / visual stories	Story comparisons Emotional prompts Historical objects	Final installation Writing / audio station Reflection prompts	On Board platform Email / notifications Events & community
OPPORTUNITIES	Create an inviting first impression that sparks curiosity.	Make the ticket feel personal, meaningful and collectible.	Use interactive tech to deepen engagement and immersion.	Highlight emotional parallels to build deeper connection.	Make sharing easy, safe and empowering.	Keep the journey alive and bring visitors back through the door.

JOURNEY INSIGHT

Wei comes to the museum with quiet questions about belonging. On Board helps her see that migration stories are diverse, personal, and connected — and that her story is part of a living community.

SUCCESS MEANS

Wei leaves feeling seen, connected and empowered. She contributes her story and continues the journey beyond the museum — as part of a community that grows together.



THE EXPERIENCE iN ACTION



SCAN AND TRY



PHYSICAL LAYER

What visitors touch to begin their journey.



Ticket printing

Self-serve kiosk with thermal printer.
Custom cut paper stock in bold colour.
Each ticket carries visitor info on the front
and a unique QR code on the back.



Under
AUD
\$0.50
per ticket



NFC tags

Passive 13.56 MHz sticker per exhibit.
Programmed with a unique exhibit URL.
No power source. No maintenance.
Interaction logged server-side on tap.



AUD
**\$0,30–
\$1.00**
per tag

IN-MUSEUM DIGITAL LAYER

What happens inside the museum.



Flight Map kiosk

Touchscreen installation. Visitor scans
ticket QR to view live journey progress —
exhibits visited, moments saved,
next NFC point.



AUD
**\$3,000–
\$6,000**



Exhibit NFC response

On tap, visitor's session is identified.
Fellow traveller's story fragment
surfaces. Moment logged to cloud.
No app required.



Included
in web
platform



Arrival Screen

Large-format display at museum exit.
Shows full journey map. Invites
visitor to contribute a reflection
to the community archive.



AUD
**\$2,000–
\$4,000**

CLOUD PLATFORM

Where data lives and stories connect.



Web platform

Lightweight responsive website. QR session linking,
NFC exhibit pages, journey map, community archive,
multi-language support. No app download required.



AUD
**\$15,000–
\$30,000**
one-time build



Server hosting

All journey data stored server-side,
keyed to ticket number. Permanently retained.
Accessible on re-scan at any future date.



AUD
\$50–\$200
/ month



Estimated pilot investment

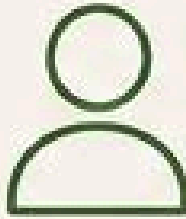
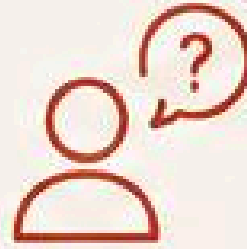
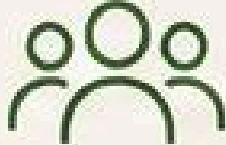
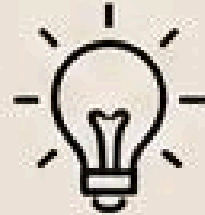
5 NFC points • 1 ticket kiosk • 1 Flight Map • 1 Arrival Screen • Core web platform

AUD \$20,000–\$40,000

One-time • ongoing: hosting + paper stock only

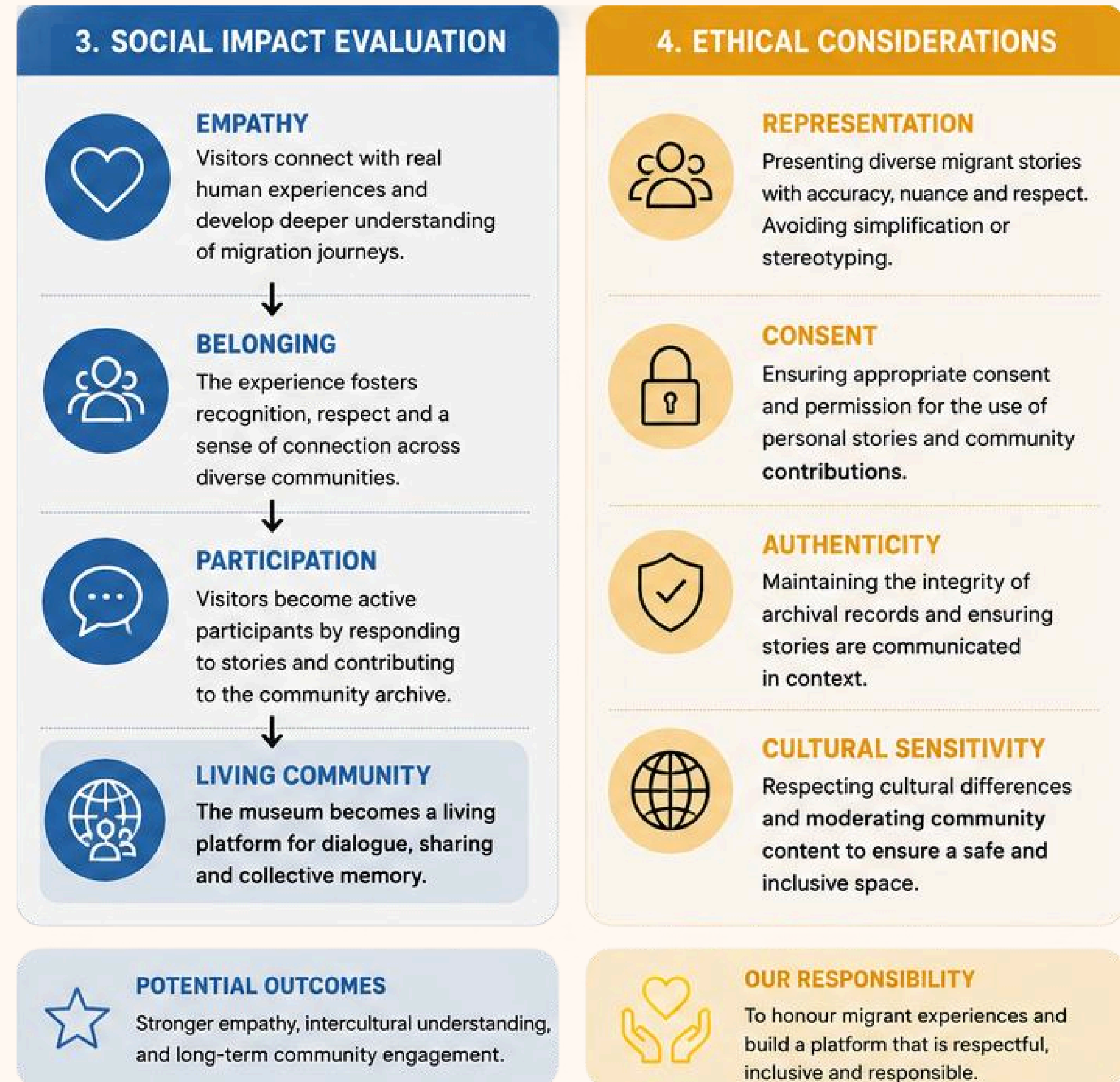
REFLECTION ON THE DESIGN PROCESS

This reflection evaluates the strengths, challenges, and key lessons learned during the development of On Board. It considers how the project evolved from an initial opportunity into a participatory museum experience.

 1. WHAT WORKED WELL	 2. WHAT DID NOT WORK AS EXPECTED
 Personal Connection Assigning each visitor a Fellow Traveller created an emotional connection with real migrant stories, transforming visitors from observers into participants.	 Visitor Commitment Not all visitors may wish to engage with a complete narrative journey. Some may prefer shorter or more flexible interactions.
 Narrative Continuity The physical ticket and tap points provided a narrative thread that connected multiple exhibitions into one meaningful journey.	 Archive Limitations The depth and completeness of migrant records vary, making it challenging to ensure consistency across different Fellow Travellers.
 Community Engagement Extending the experience beyond the museum through the digital platform encourages visitors to stay connected, share, and contribute.	 Further Testing Required The proposal has been developed at a conceptual prototype level. User testing is needed to evaluate behaviour, engagement, and accessibility in real contexts.
 KEY LEARNING Designing for participation requires balancing meaningful narratives, flexible experiences, and inclusive access.	

SOCIAL IMPACT & ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

This section examines the broader impact of On Board, including its potential to foster empathy and participation, as well as the ethical responsibilities involved in representing real migrant stories and communities.





THE STORIES EXIST

01 · COLLECTION ACCESS

Licence migrant narratives from the Gung Family Collection and additional archive holdings as fellow traveller content.

The design activates what is already here — no new material required.

Each fellow traveller is drawn directly from the museum's own records, photographs, and first-person accounts.



No new content required.
Only activation.



THE COMMUNITY EXISTS

02 · COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIP

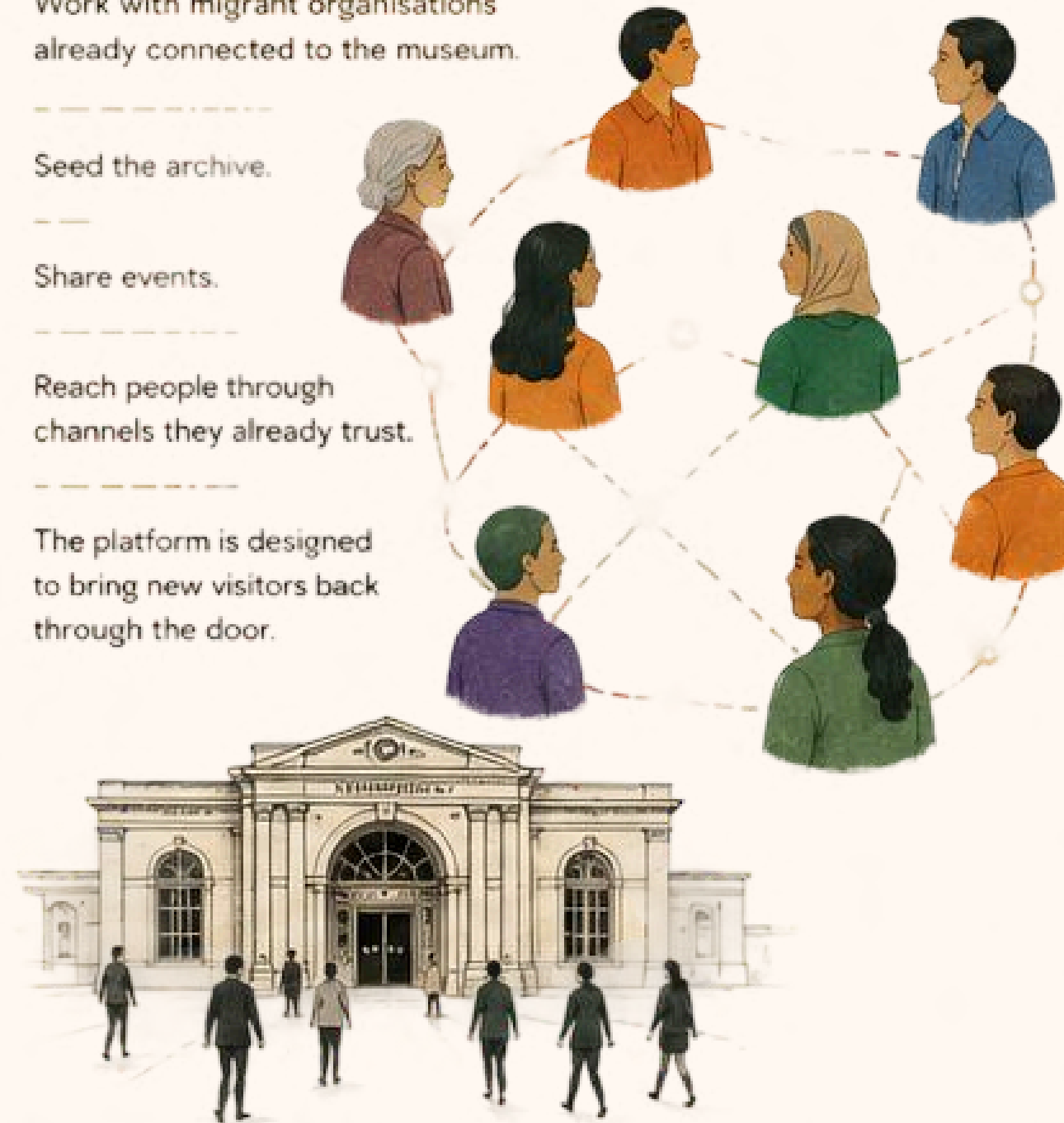
Work with migrant organisations already connected to the museum.

Seed the archive.

Share events.

Reach people through channels they already trust.

The platform is designed to bring new visitors back through the door.



THE PROGRAM ALREADY EXISTS

03 · ON BOARD FOR SCHOOLS

A field visit to the Immigration Museum revealed a significant existing use case: school groups exploring the museum in teams, led by teachers — without personal devices.

On Board for Schools extends the same intervention through museum-provided tablets or NFC readers.

Each group receives a ticket assigned to a different fellow traveller.

At the Arrival Screen, all groups' journeys appear together — opening into a shared classroom conversation about migration, identity, and belonging.

No additional platform development required.





Naomi - Xiao Li

Student ID
35963328

WELCOME TO THE FIGMA WORKSPACE TO VIEW THE DESIGN PROCESS.

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A Participatory Design Intervention for the Immigration Museum, Melbourne